

4, If We Must Say, the United States is the Foremost Contributor to the Anti-Fascist War

Consequently, the answer to a highly controversial question on the Chinese internet—namely, *which country contributed the most to the people's anti-fascist war worldwide*—is entirely self-evident.

If the question were "which country contributed the most in *World War II*," then this would largely remain a purely military question, comparing which of the Allied powers destroyed the enemy's war capacity to the greatest extent.

But once the question shifts to the *anti-fascist war*, it transcends the military realm entirely. **Because fascism is an ideology; it is a social system.**

Strategic bombing, deep operations (大纵深突击), and decisive fleet battles are indeed sufficient to annihilate fascist *armies*, but they are insufficient to annihilate *fascism*—unless the Allies intended to execute a "Three Alls" scorched-earth policy (三光政策) against the nations where the soil for fascism existed.

What truly eradicated fascism after the victory of World War II was nothing else but the brand-new world order led and established by the United States.

Integrated into this system, Germany and Japan no longer needed to resort to war to fulfill their needs; agricultural products, industrial raw materials, labor, and markets could all be obtained within this new international system at a reasonable cost.

Simultaneously, while occupying Germany and Japan, the Allied forces utilized political means to purge the power of the old **feudal nobility** (旧封建贵族) and rectify economic relations detrimental to the development of capitalism—such as the agricultural land reform (农地改革) in Japan.

When the new world order could resolve the critical problem of insufficient capitalist development for latecomer capitalist countries like Germany, Italy, and Japan, and once the domestic forces obstructing social progress in these countries were weakened, fascism simply no longer possessed the soil to grow in these nations.

And at the end of 1945, which country in the entire world possessed the capability to create such a new world order? It could only be the United States, and indeed, it accomplished it.

The international order spearheaded by the United States bears epoch-making significance in human history because it is the first world order capable of universally benefiting its participating nations and enabling massive development—that is, the first *non-zero-sum* world order in history.

It is the most remarkable progress since the US took over global leadership from Britain, and the overall peaceful situation of human society over the past few decades relies entirely upon it. If American global leadership possesses any legitimacy, it derives precisely from this.

Therefore, we can firmly say: **Annihilating fascist armies relied on anti-fascist armies. But annihilating fascism itself relied on the brand-new international order epitomized by the United Nations, the International Monetary Fund, and the World Trade Organization.**

Without such an international order to resolve the inevitable problems faced by Germany, Italy, and Japan, would the anti-fascist war have truly ended with Japan's surrender?

Actually, the answer is glaringly obvious. Never forget that the Entente Powers similarly achieved military victory in World War I. Yet, why was there a universal realization by the end of 1918 that the so-called post-war peace was nothing more than an "interwar period" (间战期)?

This was simply because too many countries completely failed to realize their interest demands during WWI. Germany ceded territory and paid massive reparations due to defeat; Italy gained only a sliver of borderland from the collapsed Austro-Hungarian Empire; and the Japanese were utterly unsatisfied with merely taking over Germany's already pitifully sparse interests in the Far East.

The fact is, only a few years after the war ended, war preparations were already in full swing. When France was constructing the Maginot Line, the Weimar Republic was still trying every possible means to deal with reparations. When the Americans were formulating *War Plan Orange* (橙色方案) to prepare for a decisive battleship clash with Japan, Japan was still in the *Taishō Democracy* (大正民主) era!

"There's going to be another massive war soon"—this was fundamentally not a secret in the 1920s.

During Hitler's first six years in power, the very reason Britain and France frequently adopted the policy of appeasement (绥靖政策) was, in a sense, because their decision-makers fundamentally believed in their hearts that Germany harbored the desire and the capability to launch the next war. Furthermore, both nations were acutely aware that Germany's interest demands had not been met, thus attempting to partially satisfy those demands in exchange for Germany not going to war.

Suppose by the end of World War II this problem had still not been resolved. What reason would we have not to believe that it would merely be *another* 20-year armistice?

Therefore, we can state with absolute certainty: in the people's anti-fascist war worldwide, the country that made the greatest contribution is unequivocally the United States.

Anyone who believes the answer is the Soviet Union is, in reality, a quintessential vulgar materialist (唯物质论的人). No matter how superior weapons and equipment may be, they cannot fight on their own; ultimately, it is humans who wield them.

It is exactly like when Qin Shi Huang (秦始皇) confiscated all the weapons in the realm to cast the Twelve Metal Colossi (十二金人), yet still failed to stop the surging tide of anti-Qin uprisings. Ultimately, aiming merely to destroy the enemy's military capacity is far inferior to ensuring they never become an enemy again!

This resonates perfectly with the famous proverb by the Ming Dynasty philosopher Wang Yangming (王阳明): **"Defeating the thieves in the mountains is easy; defeating the thieves in the mind is difficult."** (破山中贼易，破心中贼难)

Of course, recognizing on a political level that the United States achieved unparalleled merit in the anti-fascist war does not in any way negate the colossal military contributions it made.

Whether it was the strategic bombing of Germany and Japan, the military aid provided to Allied nations like the Soviet Union and China, the opening of the second front, the total annihilation of

the Imperial Japanese Navy, or the powerful containment the US and Britain exerted on the Axis powers from the "exterior lines" (外线 / *referring to regions outside the Eurasian "World Island" [世界岛]*)—their strategic military significance is simply immeasurable.

Not to mention, America's formidable industrial production capacity and scientific prowess made the nation itself a powerful pillar of confidence for the other Allied nations.

Therefore, even from a purely military perspective, the United States' contribution to World War II is second to none, and highly likely no less than that of the Soviet Union. Such so-called "contribution values" are inherently difficult to quantify.

The long-standing practice in our country's historical narrative of deliberately downplaying the United States' contributions to World War II and the global anti-fascist war is, in my view, profoundly idiotic (愚蠢至极). **Belittling others does not make oneself greater.**

4，非要说的话，美国是反法西斯战争的头号功臣

因而在我国互联网上颇有争议的一个问题，也即在世界人民反法西斯战争中贡献最大的国家是哪个，的答案是不言自明的。如果说哪个国家在第二次世界大战中贡献最大的话，那么这个问题大约还是一个比较纯粹的军事问题，比的是同盟国中究竟哪个国家最大程度消灭了敌人的战争能力。但是一旦问题变成反法西斯战争，那么这就已经远远不限于一个军事问题了，因为法西斯是一种意识形态，是一种社会体制。战略轰炸，大纵深突击，舰队决战确实足以消灭法西斯军队，却不足以消灭法西斯，除非同盟国打算对于存在法西斯诞生土壤的国家采取三光政策。在二次大战胜利之后真正消灭法西斯的不是别的，正是以美国主导并建立的全新的世界秩序，被纳入这个体系的德国和日本可以不再通过战争的方式来解决其需要，农业产品，工业原料，劳动力和市场都在这个全新的国际体系内以合理的代价获得。盟军在对德日两国进行占领的同时也通过政治手段清退了旧封建贵族的势力，纠正了对于资本主义发展不利的经济关系，例如在日本进行的农地改革。当新的世界秩序能够满足德意日之流后发资本主义国家解决资本主义发展不充分的这个重大问题，而它们国内阻碍社会进步的势力被削弱之后，法西斯主义在这些国家就不再拥有产生的土壤。

而在 1945 年底的时候，全世界哪个国家有能力去创造这样一种新世界秩序呢？只可能是美国，而且它也的确做到了。美国所主导的国际秩序在人类历史上具有划时代意义，因为它是第一个能够使其中的国家普遍受益并取得长足发展的世界秩序，也就是有史以来第一个非零和的世界秩序。它是美国从英国手中接过世界领导权之后最为显著的进步，人类社会过去几十年间总体和平的局面有赖于此。如果说美国人领导世界能有什么合法性的话那么非它莫属。因此我们可以说，消灭法西斯军队靠的是反法西斯军队。但是要消灭法西斯主义本身，靠的是以联合国、国际货币基金组织、世界贸易组织为代表的崭新的国际秩序。

如果没有这样的国际秩序去解决德意日三国所不得不面临的问题，那么反法西斯战争会以日本投降结束吗？其实答案是很明显的，千万别忘了协约国在第一次世界大战中一样取得了军事胜利，可为什么在 1918 年底战争结束的时候人们就普遍意识到所谓战后和平不过是一个间战期罢了。这无非是因为太多国家在一战中根本没有实现自己的利益诉求，德国因为战败进行割地赔款，意大利从崩溃的奥匈帝国那里获得了一点边疆土地，日本人也不满足于只接收德国人在远东本来就是少得可怜的利益。事实就是，战争结束没几年的时候备战工作已经如火如荼地展开了，法国修建马其诺防线的时候，魏玛共和国还在试图以各种办法应付赔款，美国人制定橙色方案准备和日本大打战列舰决战的时候，日本还处于大正民主时代。“马上又要打大仗”，这件事在 20 世纪 20 年代根本就不是秘密。希特勒夺取政权的头六年里，英国法国之所以频繁地采取绥靖政策，某种意义上就已经说明决策者从内心完全相信德国希望也有能力发动下一场战争。并且两国很清楚德国的利益诉求没有被满足，因此试图通过部分满足德国的利益诉求来换取他不进行战争。假设到第二次世界大战结束的时候这一问题还没能得到解决，那么我们有什么理由不去认为这又是 20 年的停战呢？

因此我们可以说，在世界人民反法西斯战争中立下功劳最大的国家毫无疑问是美国，任何认为回答是苏联的人才是真正唯物论的人，再好的武器装备都不会自己作战，使用他们的终究是人。就好比秦始皇当年收天下之兵铸成十二金人却依然无法阻止反秦起义的浪潮一样，以消灭敌人的军事能力为目的终究不如从此不再为敌，这倒像了王阳明所说的，破山中贼易，破心中贼难。当然，我们从政治层面上认为美国在反法西斯战争中立下了一番功，这不是否定美国在军事上所做出的巨大贡献。无论是对德日两国的战略轰炸，对于苏联和中国等盟国的军事援助，开辟第二战场并消灭日本帝国海军还是美国同英国一道在外线（指的是欧亚大陆这个世界岛之外）对轴心国所起到的有力牵制，其军事战略意义都不可估量。更何况美国强大的工业生产能力和科技实力使得美国本身就是其他盟国一个有力的信心支撑。因此即使从军事角度看，美国在第二次世界大战中所做出的贡献也是数一数二的，很可能不会低于苏联，这种所谓的贡献值是难以量化的。在我国的历史叙事中长期贬低美国为二次大战及世界人民反法西斯战争所做出的贡献，这在我看来确实愚蠢至极，即使贬低他者也不能使自己变得更伟大。